

Chapter 151 - Part 1

No one could help her answer this question.

Xu Qingzhu herself couldn't figure it out either. She only knew that she was extremely irritable, and her whole body was in pain.

Yet there were clearly no wounds.

The sun in this foreign land carried warmth, unlike the cold winter sun of Haizhou City.

But Xu Qingzhu still felt cold all over.

She sat on the bed with her arms crossed, her entire complexion pale, her forehead covered in cold sweat.

She opened her mouth numbly, but didn't know what to say, and finally closed it again.

Both the room and the phone fell into a deathly silence.

After a moment, Xu Qingzhu said coldly: "Go back to sleep. I need some quiet."

Without waiting for Liang Shi to react, she hung up the phone.

Xu Qingzhu turned her face to look outside. The hotel's glass was wiped spotlessly clean, and sunlight penetrated through, bright and dazzling.

Her phone didn't ring, but after a while, she received a message from Liang Shi.

【Babe, don't feel bad. When you're ready, tell me what happened. I'll be here all day.】

Xu Qingzhu stared at the screen for a long while, then closed her phone and tossed it aside.

She lay on the bed somewhat dejectedly.

She fell asleep again, and was once again jolted awake by the nightmare.

The same dream, the same suffocating feeling.

Xu Qingzhu refused to give in. After recovering slightly, she tried to fall asleep again.

From initially falling asleep quickly to later lying there with her brain playing images like a slideshow, it became very difficult to fall asleep.

For almost the entire afternoon, she was wrestling with her dreams.

Rather than wrestling with her dreams, it was more like wrestling with herself.

Everything in the dreams kept telling her: Liang Shi is going to kill you.

And when Liang Shi was killing her, someone would reach out to help her.

Xu Qingzhu fell into dreams again and again, and was frightened awake again and again.

Dreams had become the thing she feared most.

Once, after waking up, she had the impulse to call Liang Shi again and ask her why she wanted to kill her.

But before she could make the call, she came to her senses first.

This was too painful.

So painful that she didn't want to sleep. Her entire mood was low, and even her mental state was affected. That night, she inexplicably lost her temper at the secretary.

During this time, Liang Shi sent her several messages asking how she was doing.

She replied with text messages: 【Feeling better.】

And another: 【Busy.】

Cold and distant.

Xu Qingzhu didn't know how to suppress this emotion, so she drank a lot of alcohol before bed.

After drinking too much, she received a message from Liang Shi: 【Are you done with work? Is it convenient to video call?】

Xu Qingzhu replied with: 【Mm.】

At that moment, she was sitting in a chair in her room—more accurately, she was curled up in the chair with both legs pulled up, arms hugging her legs. It was a very insecure posture.

On Liang Shi's side, it was still evening. The sky was filled with rosy clouds, the orange-pink clouds like blush on a young girl's face, dreamlike and ethereal.

She was sitting on the bay window in the room, with Xu Qingzhu's pile of plushies behind her.

Her overall state wasn't good, somewhat dejected.

She looked at Xu Qingzhu. "Have you been drinking?"

Xu Qingzhu nodded, pressing her temples as she said: "I've been having nightmares all day."

"What nightmares?" Liang Shi asked. "Can you tell me?"

"I dreamed that you were going to kill me," Xu Qingzhu said. "My heart hurts so much..."

Xu Qingzhu had drunk too much, and her words came out sad and pained: "I feel like I'm being torn apart. One half says you're not that kind of person, while the other half keeps replaying the scenes of you killing me."

"Kill you?" Liang Shi pressed her lips together, her voice deep. "With what?"

Xu Qingzhu stared at her through the screen: "A knife."

Xu Qingzhu's eyes suddenly lit up. "A very sharp knife."

"Do you believe it?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu paused for a moment, then slowly shook her head.

But after just a moment, her eyes showed confusion and pain. "But it hurts so much."

"Where?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu pressed her lips together and answered very slowly: "My heart, and here... and here..."

She pointed to behind her ear and her chest.

"I... I feel like I'm being influenced by something." Xu Qingzhu tried hard to distinguish between the two states. "I can't resist it. Once I try to resist, that thing clings to me desperately... I... I have no way out."

Her brows furrowed tightly.

Liang Shi fell silent after hearing this.